Ideation Phase
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	03 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-3942
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Team members: Dhanalakshmi Pl (Team Leader), Dhalapathi C, Dhanalakshmi S and Dhanusri S B.

Project problem statement	Brainstorming focus
Employee details arrive as a spreadsheet and must be loaded into ServiceNow quickly and correctly, without creating duplicate employees, and then presented in a way HR can use.	Find the simplest end-to-end route: stage the file in an Import Set table, map it with a Transform Map, use Employee ID to match existing records, check the result, and report on it.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Idea Group	Ideas brainstormed by the team
Data Preparation	Build a sample employee sheet in Google Sheets with Employee ID, Name, Email, Department and Location, then download it as an Excel (.xlsx) file.
Target Table	Create a custom Employee Test table (u_employee_test) with matching fields for the five columns.
Import Set	Use System Import Sets > Load Data to create the Employee Import staging table (u__employee_import) from the file.
Transform Map	Create the Sample Spreadsheet Import Transform Map and use Auto Map Matching Fields, then map any remaining column by hand.
Coalesce	Treat Employee ID as the unique key so a repeated import updates an existing employee instead of adding another.
Transform Scripts	Add a field script where a value needs cleaning or converting, such as a date format or a choice value.
Validation	Compare the spreadsheet row count with Transform History and the Employee Test list; review ignored or error rows.
Reports	Build an Employee List report, an Employees by Department pie chart and an Employees by Location bar chart.
Dashboard	Place the three reports on one Employee Analytics Dashboards page for HR.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Priority	Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Reason
1	Import Set staging table	High	High	Every import starts here; the file must be staged before it can be transformed.
2	Transform Map with field mapping	High	High	This is the core step that carries each spreadsheet column into the right target field.
3	Coalesce on Employee ID	High	High	Prevents duplicate employees and lets repeated imports update existing records.
4	Validation with Transform History	High	High	Proves the result: how many rows were inserted, updated, ignored or rejected.
5	Data preparation in the spreadsheet	Medium	High	Clean, consistent input reduces errors before the transform runs.
6	Transform scripts	Medium	Medium	Needed only for values that cannot be copied as they are.
7	Reports and dashboard	Medium	High	Gives HR a clear view of employees by department and location.

Prioritization summary: The Import Set + Transform Map workflow is the central idea. Coalesce on Employee ID and validation through Transform History protect data quality. Reports and the dashboard extend the solution so the imported data is easy to monitor.